

— LEGENDS · NO. 14

THE GENTLEMAN OF FOOTBALL.

Andrés Escobar · Colombia · 1967 to 1994.

A 6-part breakdown

SWIPE ►►►

0101 / 06

| THE HEART OF A GOLDEN SIDE.

A composed, ball-playing centre-half, Escobar anchored the Colombia team that lit up the late 80s and early 90s. *Calm on the ball before it was fashionable.*



0202 / 06

| CHAMPIONS OF A CONTINENT.

In 1989 he helped Atlético Nacional win the Copa Libertadores, the first ever for a Colombian club. A landmark that still defines the country's game.

0303 / 06

| EL CABALLERO DEL FÚTBOL.

The Gentleman of Football. The name was about conduct as much as quality: fair, measured, respectful, every match.

0404 / 06

| A LEADER, QUIETLY.

Captain material without the theatrics. He led by standard, not by volume, the kind of defender team-mates set their watch by.

0505 / 06

| GONE TOO SOON.

His life ended in 1994, days after the World Cup, at just 27. A loss Colombian football still feels.

0606 / 06

| THE STANDARD THAT REMAINS.

Three decades on he is remembered as one of Colombia's finest, and as the measure of how the game should be carried.

— THE TAKEAWAY

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